

Term test 1 review

Chapters 1-3 Introduction to Mass Media

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1. Mass Communication

1.1 Culture and Evolution of Mass Communication

1.1.1 Culture 文化

- Culture → art: unique forms of creative expression that give pleasure and set standards about what is true, good, and beautiful.
- Culture: a society's art, beliefs, customs, games, technologies, traditions, and institutions.
- Communication 沟通、传播: the creation and use of symbol systems that convey information and meaning (example: languages, Morse code, motion pictures, and computer codes)

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- Culture = symbols of expression to make sense of life and articulate values
- Mass media 大众媒体= helps circulate those values (channels of communication → video games, internet services, TV shows, newspapers, movies etc.)
- Mass communication 大众传播: the process of designing cultural messages and stories and delivering them to large and diverse audiences through media channels as old and distinctive as the printed book and as new and converged as the Internet.

1.1.2 Oral and Written Communication 口头和书面交流

- Face-to-face, question-and-answer discussions
- Do aspects of contemporary culture, such as reality TV shows, Twitter, and social networking sites, cheapen public discussion and discourage face-to-face communication?

1.1.3 The Print Revolution 印刷革命

- Gradually, printers reduced the size and cost of books, making them available and affordable to more people.
- Books became the 1st mass-marketed products in history.
- 3 elements for mass-market innovation: machine duplication (industrialization 工业化), large quantities can be produced easily, lower the cost → more affordable and available to less affluent people
- Print media became key tools that commercial and political leaders used to distribute information and maintain social order
- Printing press fostered **nationalism** 民族主义 and **individualism** 个人主义: industrialization required a more educated workforce; people came to rely less on their local community and their leaders for guidance.
- Nationalism 民族主义: support one's own nation especially exclude others.
- Individualism 个人主义: favoring freedom of action for individuals over collective 集体 or state control.

1.1.4 The Electronic and Digital Eras 电子和数字化时代

- The telegraph made 4 key contributions to communication:
 1. It separated communication from transportation
 2. Transformed information into commodity

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3. Made it easier for military, business, and political leaders to coordinate commercial and military operations
 4. Let to future technological developments
- In digital communication, images, texts, and sounds are converted or encoded into electronic signals that are then reassembled or decoded as a precise reproduction of a TV picture, a magazine article, a song, or a telephone voice.
 - Social media: are digital applications that allow people from all over the world to have ongoing online conversations, share stories and interests, and generate their own media content.

1.1.5 Dual Roles of Media Convergence 媒体融合的双重作用

- 1st role: involves the technological merging of content across different media channels:
 - Magazine articles, radio programs, songs, TV shows, and movies now available on the Internet through laptops, iPads, and smartphones.
- 2nd role: cross platform → describes a business model that involves consolidating various media holdings, such as cable connections, phone services, television transmissions, and Internet access, under one corporate umbrella.
 - The goal is not to offer consumers more choice in their media options, but to better manage resources and maximize profits.
 - Rather than having each radio station, TV station, newspaper, and online news site generate diverse and independent stories about an issue, a media corporation employing the convergence model can use fewer employees to generate multiple versions of the same story.

1.1.6 The Linear Model of Mass Communication 大众传媒的线性模型

- Senders transmit messages through a mass media channel to large groups of receivers.
- **Senders** 发出者 → authors, producers, organizations
- **Messages** 信息 → programs, texts, images, sounds, and ads
- **Mass media channel** 大众传媒的渠道 → newspapers, books, magazines, radio, television, or the internet
- **Receivers** 接收者 → readers, viewers, and consumers
- In the process, **gatekeepers** 监督者 → news editors, executive producers, and other

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media managers, function as message filters

- **Feedback** 反馈 → a process in which citizens and consumers return messages to senders or gatekeepers through letters-to-the-editor, phone calls, e-mail, web postings, or talk shows.

1.1.7 A Cultural Model of Mass Communication 大众传媒的文化性模型

- *Cultural model*: individuals bring diverse meanings to messages, given factors and differences such as gender, age, educational level, ethnicity, and occupation.
- Audiences actively affirm, interpret, refashion, or reject the messages and stories that flow through various media channels.
- **Selective exposure** 选择性暴露 → people typically seek messages and produce meanings that correspond to their own cultural beliefs, values, and interests.

1.1.8 Narratives—story, the foundation of media 传媒的叙事性特点

- The stories circulate in the media can shape a society's perception of events and attitudes.
- The stories the mass media told played a key role in changing individual awareness, cultural attitudes and even public policy.
- Narrative 叙事的 → storytelling

1.1.9 Culture as a Skyscraper 文化好比摩天大楼

- **High culture** 高雅文化 → top floors → ballet, symphony, art museum, classic literature
- **Low culture** 低俗文化 → bottom floors → soap operas, rock music, radio shock jocks, video games
- Critics concern about low culture from 5 areas:
 1. An inability to appreciate fine art 无法欣赏高雅艺术
 2. A tendency to exploit high culture 破坏了高雅文化
 3. A throw-away ethic 抛弃伦理
 4. A diminished audience for high culture 高雅文化的减少
 5. Dulling our cultural taste buds 钝化我们的文化味蕾

1.1.10 Culture as a Map 文化好比一张地图

- Culture is an ongoing and complicated process
- A cultural map suggests that we can pursue many connections from one cultural place to

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another and can appreciate a range of cultural experiences without simply ranking them from high to low.

1.1.11 Culture Values 文化价值观

- **Modern period 现代:** from the Industrial Revolution of the 19th century to the mid-20th century.
- 4 major features/values defining changes in mass media or modern period:
 1. Efficiency 高效
 2. Individualism 个人主义
 3. Rationalism 理性主义
 4. Progress 进步
- **Postmodern period 后现代:** from mid-20th century to today
- Changes in this era: music videos, remote controls, Nike ads, shopping malls, fax machines, e-mail, video games, blogs, YouTube, iPads, hip-hop, and reality TV shows.
- 4 major features/values defining changes occurred in postmodern period:
 1. Populism 民粹主义
 2. Diversity 多元化
 3. Nostalgia 怀旧风
 4. Paradox 悖论性

1.1.12 Critiquing Media and Culture 辩证的看待传媒和文化

- Media literacy and the critical process:
 1. Description描述: paying close attention, taking notes, and researching the subject under study.
 2. Analysis分析: discovering and focusing on significant patterns that emerge from the description stage.
 3. Interpretation理解: determine the meanings of the patterns we have analyzed. Asking and answering the “what does that mean?” and “so what?” questions about one’s findings.
 4. Evaluation评定: arriving at a judgement about whether something is good, bad, or mediocre, which involves subordinating one’s personal taste to the critical assessment

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resulting from the first three stages.

5. Engagement参与: taking some action that connects our critical perspective with our role as citizens to question our media institutions, adding our own voice to the process of shaping the cultural environment.

2. The Internet and Digital Media

- FOMO: fear of missing out → desire to stay continually connected with what others are doing
- Studies about happiness routinely conclude that the best path to subjective well-being and life satisfaction is having a community of close personal relationships.
- Ironically, no medium better than the Internet and its social media platforms to bring people together.

2.1 The Internet Becomes a Mass Medium

2.1.1 Invention of the Web 互联网的诞生

- 1990s
- Browsers 浏览器: software applications that help users navigate the web.
- Internet as a mass medium, allows millions of people to connect to it quickly and easily.
- Search engines 搜索引擎: offered a more automated way to find content by allowing users to enter key words or queries to locate related web pages.

2.1.2 The Internet Gets Interactive 互联网的互动性

- 2000s
- Before that time, the web → read-only; now, it became read-write or interactive platform for users to communicate information
- Interactivity → collectivity and collaboration

2.1.3 The Internet Starts to Think 互联网开始会思考

- Many types of devices: TV, tablets, smartphones
- It alters how we relate to our media environment

2.1.4 Decentralizing the Creation and Spread of Information 分散创作和信息扩散

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- Affordable digital production tools, easy access to a global network, and interactive social media features like tagging, sharing, and liking have democratized 民主化 the production and distribution of information.
- Unrestricted communication
- Problem → misinformation and disinformation
- **Misinformation** 错误信息: false or misleading information spread by people who assume it is true.
- **Disinformation** 虚假信息: false or misleading information spread knowingly by people with malicious intent.

2.1.5 Manipulating Media

- Remix culture: a term used to describe a society in which people are able to create and communicate by mixing, editing, combining, manipulating, or repurposing existing texts.
- Right of fair use: a legal doctrine that permits people to use copyrighted material without permission as long as the use does not compromise its value.

2.1.6 Controlling Data

- Surveillance capitalism 监视资本主义: an increasingly important business model that involves making money by controlling the personal data of millions of users.
- Google, Amazon, Facebook

2.1.7 Controlling Access

- **Walled gardens**: highly managed digital app environments that provide continuous streams of content directly to our feeds in an effort to discourage us from leaving to browse elsewhere: Instagram, Facebook etc.
- Opt-in policies → pushing back against tracking and data collection
- Open-source software → collective effort

2.1.8 The Internet, Digital Communication, and Democracy

- **Universal access**: the notion that every citizen, regardless of income or location, should have the opportunity to use and benefit from a technology.
- **Digital divide** 分化: refers to the growing contrast between the “information haves”—those who can afford to purchase a computer and pay for Internet services—and the

“information have-nots”—those who may not be able to afford a computer or pay for Internet services.

3. Digital Gaming and the Media Playground

3.1 How We Got Here: The Development of Digital Gaming

3.1.1 Mass production and mass consumption

- Increasing in leisure time → create moneymaking opportunities for media makers
- Mechanical gaming: coin-operated contraptions 投币式游戏机
- Consoles: devices people use specifically to play video games → put digital games on a path to becoming a mass medium, bringing gaming into households and sparking unprecedented growth in game development.

3.1.2 The Gaming Environment

- Video game genres: action, adventure, role-playing, sports, casual games
- Social gaming: the connectivity of the Internet has opened the door to social gaming—millions of people playing the same online games in virtual spaces.

3.1.3 Communities of Play

- Formation of online and in-person groups devoted to discussing other forms of mass media, such as movies, TV shows, and books
- Enhance the social experience gained through the games
- Collective intelligence: sharing of knowledge and ideas → game developers and the gaming industry pay close attention to gamers and their communities in order to gather new ideas and constructive criticism and to gauge popularity 衡量人气.
- Modding: modifying game software or hardware
- Live gaming platforms extend beyond gameplay, offering livestreamed talk show for teens, comedy from performers and livestreamed news events.
- Conventions 游戏局: where video game enthusiasts can come together in person to test out new games and other new products, play classic games in competition, and meet video game developers. → example: cosplay = costume + play

3.1.4 Digital Gaming and Society

- Addiction 上瘾 and other concerns
- Violence 暴力, misogyny 厌女症, and representation 代表 → sexual representation, racial representation etc.
- Future gaming: more interactive → virtual reality (VR) → more immerse and portable experience (will become the frontier of digital gaming)

3.1.5 The Business of Digital Gaming

- Ownership
- 3 major expenditures in game publishing:
 1. Development 研发: development budget—money spent designing, coding, scoring, and testing a new game → goes to paying talent, digital artists, and game testers.
 2. Licensing 执照: independent gamemakers deal with console manufacturers such as Microsoft, Sony for the right to distribute a game using their system → pay them royalties 版税; also the intellectual property 知识产权
 3. Marketing 市场宣传: the marketing costs of launching a digital game often equal or exceed the development costs. For example: online promotions, banner ads 横幅广告, magazine print ads, instore displays, television advertising.
- Selling digital games: 3 main pay models in the digital game industry: the boxed game/retail model, the free-to-play model, and the subscription model.

3.1.6 Digital Gaming, Free Speech, and Democracy

- Digital games—speech in an interactive medium—provide us entertainment; connect us to communities; help us express and play through our fears, our fantasies 幻想, our hopes, and our dreams.